

Aurora Utility is consolidating outage management, distributed energy resource dispatch, field work coordination, and external emergency coordination into a single storm response platform. Customer channels, DER partner integrations, and analytics run in a cloud control plane, while switching authority, telemetry historians, and firmware release remain tied to operational-technology zones and field gateways.

The platform serves customers checking outage status, municipal emergency operators prioritizing critical facilities, distribution operators dispatching load relief, field crews working from tablets with intermittent connectivity, vendor engineers collecting diagnostics, and market operators coordinating capacity commitments. During severe weather, these users interact under intense time pressure and incomplete information.

Aurora depends on DER aggregator feeds, meter telemetry, weather forecasts, and ISO dispatch schedules to decide whether to curtail load, island microgrids, or reprioritize field work. Field tablets can operate offline for hours and later resynchronize work packages and hazard notes. Vendor access is allowed only through a brokered enclave, but the same shared services that support diagnostics also sit close to SCADA adapters and firmware signing workflows.

Break-glass dispatch is the defining high-risk path. It exists so the utility can move quickly during wildfire, ice storm, or feeder instability events, but it also creates a legitimate mechanism to bypass ordinary reviews. The audit vault is supposed to make those actions provable, yet operators and reviewers already suspect that telemetry gaps, offline replay, and partner trust assumptions could let a determined attacker or pressured insider make unsafe decisions look operationally justified.